

CLASS ACT *The Tragedy of Ham MacLear* being staged; inset, a scene from *The Queen*

The festival will kick off with Maneesh Verma's *Dancing with Dad*, and continue with *Breast of Luck*, *Amb Da Boota*, *The Tragedy of Ham MacLear*, *Window Tak Aashiqui*, *Cilappatikaram/ The Anklet's Verdict*, *Har Marz Ki Dawa*, *The Queen* and *Bhasbharatam*. It will also feature additional performances under The Theatre, including *Maaye Ni Meri Akh Lag Gayi*, *Home in a Suitcase* and *Hindi Medium Tight*. Says Syed Shadab Hussain, head - programmes, IHC, "From contemporary narratives and adaptations to regional and classical traditions, the selection brings together very different theatrical experiences. At the same time, we wanted each production to have a distinct voice and something meaningful to offer the audience."

OVER THE YEARS, THE FESTIVAL HAS STAGED THE WORK OF SEVERAL EMINENT THEATRE PERSONALITIES, SHOWCASING LANDMARK PRODUCTIONS

Over the years, the festival has presented the work of several eminent theatre personalities, showcased landmark productions and developed collaborations with leading theatre institutions and organisations. As a self-funded, non-commercial initiative, the festival places the performing arts ahead of the bottom line. Affordable ticket pricing (Rs 200-500) ensures accessibility, with an annual audience of over 5,000. ■

—Deepali Dhingra

To be held at Stein Auditorium, India Habitat Centre, Delhi, from Sept. 18-27

▼ **SEPT. 24** | *Experimental Theatre, NCPA, Mumbai*

Piano Recital by Andrei Korobeinikov

The Russian pianist comes to Mumbai with a programme spanning Beethoven, Scriabin and Keith Jarrett. Presented by the Mehli Mehta Music Foundation, the evening promises an intriguing meeting of contrasting musical worlds.



▼ **SEPT. 12-27** | *Multi-City India Tour*

Sukoon Tour



Part of Once Upon India's 20-city tour, *Sukoon* is an intimate mehfil celebrating music, poetry and shared memories. Utkarsh Sharma brings together ghazals associated with Jagjit Singh, melodies by Kishore Kumar and poetry by Gulzar, accompanied by sarangi, tabla, guitar and harmonium. The tour visits Jaipur, Delhi-NCR, Pune and Mumbai, offering a gently-paced celebration of familiar songs and timeless poetry.

▼ **SEPT. 12** | *The Grand Theatre, NMACC, Mumbai*

SHUJAAT KHAN & TALAT AZIZ: **STRINGS & SING**

Strings & Sing brings together two celebrated names for an evening centred on melody, poetry and artistry. Grammy-nominated sitarist, Ustad Shujaat Khan, is renowned for his distinctive *gayaki ang* style, which draws on the expressive nuances of the human voice. Following his performance, acclaimed ghazal singer Talat Aziz will present a selection from his repertoire.



—Compiled by ***Nikhil Sardana***